



Emergency-Ready

A simple kit checklist for beginners

Peace of mind for camping, the car, and home. Know exactly what to pack so you are ready, not scared, without the overwhelm.

FOR FIRST-TIMERS · HOME · CAR · CAMPING

START HERE

Ready, not scared

A quick note before you build your kit.

Being prepared is not about fear. It is the opposite. When you know that a scraped knee, a sudden storm, a dead phone, or a power outage is already handled, you get to relax and actually enjoy the outdoors and everyday life.

You do not need to be a survival expert or spend a fortune. Most emergencies for regular families are small and common, and a few basics in one place solve almost all of them.

This kit walks you through exactly what to pack for home, car, and camping, plus a first-aid list, a family plan, and a contacts card. Check the boxes as you go. Build it in an afternoon.

🎯 **The one habit that matters most:** build one kit, keep it packed, and do not raid it for everyday use. A ready kit you never touch is a kit that is there when you need it.

⚠️ This is a beginner-friendly checklist, not medical or professional emergency training. Always follow local guidance, and in a real emergency, call your local emergency number.

The 5 essentials

Do not memorize a huge list. Just think in these 5 simple buckets, everything else is a detail.



1. First aid

For the small stuff that happens most: cuts, scrapes, blisters, headaches.



2. Water, food & warmth

What your body needs first: clean water, food, and staying dry and warm.



3. Light & power

A way to see in the dark and keep your phone alive.



4. Info & comms

A way to get news and reach help, plus your key contacts written down.



5. Tools & extras

The little items that fix problems: multi-tool, tape, cash, copies.

👉 **How to use the next pages:** there is a checklist for your **home**, your **car**, and your **camping** kit. Start with one. Check boxes as you pack.

Home emergency kit

The grab-and-go basics for a power outage, storm, or evacuation.

FIRST AID

- ☐ First-aid kit (see the first-aid page)
- ☐ One week of any needed medications
- ☐ Hygiene: wipes, hand sanitizer, toilet paper

WATER, FOOD & WARMTH

- ☐ Bottled water (aim for 1 gallon per person, per day, 3 days)
- ☐ Non-perishable food for 3 days + a manual can opener
- ☐ Blankets or emergency blankets, warm layers

LIGHT & POWER

- ☐ Flashlight or headlamp + spare batteries
- ☐ Power bank (charged) + charging cables

INFO & COMMS

- ☐ Battery or hand-crank radio
- ☐ Copies of IDs, insurance, and this contacts card in a zip bag

TOOLS & EXTRAS

- ☐ Some cash in small bills
- ☐ Whistle, multi-tool, duct tape, work gloves

Car emergency kit

For breakdowns, getting stuck, or being on the road when something happens.

FIRST AID

- ☐ Small first-aid kit

WATER, FOOD & WARMTH

- ☐ Bottled water + snacks that keep (bars, nuts)
- ☐ Blanket + warm layers, hat and gloves

LIGHT & POWER

- ☐ Flashlight or headlamp + spare batteries
- ☐ Phone power bank + cable

INFO & COMMS

- ☐ Reflective triangle or flares
- ☐ Cash, and a printed copy of your contacts card

TOOLS & EXTRAS

- ☐ Jumper cables or a jump-start pack
- ☐ Tire pressure gauge + a way to inflate (or a sealant)
- ☐ Ice scraper (if you get cold weather)
- ☐ Multi-tool, duct tape, paper towels

P Tip: keep a full water bottle and a blanket in the car year-round. They are the two things people most wish they had.

Camping emergency kit

The "just in case" items that turn a scary moment into a small one on the trail.

FIRST AID

- ☐ First-aid kit + any personal meds
- ☐ Poison oak / poison ivy relief (anti-itch or calamine)
- ☐ Sunscreen + lip balm (chapstick)
- ☐ Bug spray

WATER, FOOD & WARMTH

- ☐ Extra water + a way to purify (tablets or filter)
- ☐ Extra snacks with calories
- ☐ Emergency blanket or bivvy
- ☐ Rain jacket / extra dry layer

LIGHT & POWER

- ☐ Headlamp + spare batteries
- ☐ Charged phone + power bank (service can be spotty)

INFO & COMMS

- ☐ Whistle (3 blasts = help) + a small mirror
- ☐ Paper map of the area + a compass
- ☐ Tell someone your plan and return time before you go

TOOLS & EXTRAS

- ☐ Multi-tool or knife + duct tape
- ☐ Waterproof matches or a lighter, in a dry bag

First-aid kit

The basics that cover the small injuries families deal with most. Keep one at home, one in the car, one for camping.

WOUND CARE

- ☐ Adhesive bandages, assorted sizes
- ☐ Gauze pads + medical tape
- ☐ Antiseptic wipes + antibiotic ointment
- ☐ Blister bandages (a hiker's best friend)
- ☐ Tweezers + small scissors
- ☐ Disposable gloves

MEDICINE & COMFORT

- ☐ Pain / fever reliever (adult + child, if needed)
- ☐ Antihistamine for allergic reactions
- ☐ Anti-itch cream + aloe for burns/bites
- ☐ Any personal prescriptions
- ☐ Elastic bandage for sprains + instant cold pack
- ☐ A small card with allergies & emergency contacts

FILL IT IN TOGETHER

Our family emergency plan

Ten minutes now saves panic later. Fill this in and keep a copy in each kit.

If we get separated, we meet at...

MEETING SPOT NEAR HOME

MEETING SPOT OUTSIDE THE NEIGHBORHOOD

Our out-of-town contact (one person everyone calls)

NAME

PHONE

Kids should know

WHO TO CALL & HOW (EMERGENCY NUMBER)

A TRUSTED NEIGHBOR / ADULT NEARBY

Where our kit lives

AT HOME

IN THE CAR

FILL IT IN · THEN PRINT & CUT FOR EACH KIT

Important info card

Because you cannot rely on a phone that may be dead or lost.

Emergency contacts

EMERGENCY NUMBER

FAMILY DOCTOR

PARENT / GUARDIAN 1

PARENT / GUARDIAN 2

OUT-OF-TOWN CONTACT

POISON CONTROL / VET

Medical notes (per family member)

NAME · ALLERGIES · MEDICATIONS · BLOOD TYPE

NAME · ALLERGIES · MEDICATIONS · BLOOD TYPE

NAME · ALLERGIES · MEDICATIONS · BLOOD TYPE

Addresses

HOME ADDRESS

NEAREST HOSPITAL

DON'T SET IT AND FORGET IT

Keep your kit fresh

A kit only helps if it still works when you need it. Quick checks, done a few times a year.

How often	Check this
Every 3 months	Batteries work, power bank is charged, flashlight turns on
Every 6 months	Rotate water and snacks; check for anything expired
Every 6 months	Update contacts & medical info if anything changed
Once a year	Re-check clothing sizes for kids; refresh first-aid supplies
Before each trip	Grab the camping kit, top off water, confirm the plan

 **Easy trick:** tie your checks to the clocks changing or the seasons, so you never have to remember a date.

BUILD IT IN ONE TRIP

Build-your-kit shopping list

Take this to the store (or order online). Most of it is cheaper than you think, and you may already own half.

☐ Bottled water

☐ Non-perishable food

☐ Manual can opener

☐ Flashlight / headlamp

☐ Batteries (assorted)

☐ Power bank + cables

☐ Radio (battery/crank)

☐ First-aid supplies

☐ Emergency blankets

☐ Whistle

☐ Multi-tool / knife

☐ Duct tape

☐ Work gloves

☐ Wipes / sanitizer

☐ Water purification

☐ Matches / lighter

☐ Zip bags (waterproofing)

☐ Small cash

☐ Storage bin / backpack

☐ Copies of documents

 **Start with one kit.** You do not need everything at once. Build the home kit first, then add the car and camping ones over time.

YOU'RE READY

That's it, you're ready

No fear. Just a calm, capable family that has it handled.

You do not have to build the perfect kit today. You just have to start, one box checked, one item packed. A half-built kit is already better than none, and you can add to it over time.

Once your kit is ready, tuck it away and enjoy your adventures (and your everyday life) knowing that if something small goes sideways, you have got it.

 **Remember:** it does not have to be perfect, it just has to happen. Being ready is a gift you give your future self, and the people you love.

 **Safety note:** This kit is a beginner-friendly guide, not medical or professional emergency training. Customize it for your family's needs, follow local guidance, and in a real emergency, always call your local emergency number.

Stay safe out there. 

— Paola